Local SEO Masterclass

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Ranking a Local Google ...

Introduction to Local SEO

NAP Consistency + Map Emb...

Getting ONLY 5 Star Reviews f...

Getting a Google My Busines...

GMB Location + Direction Ma...

Rank and Rent (Organic S...

Introduction to Rank and Rents

Setting up a Rank and Rent

Ranking your Rank and Rent

Pricing your Rank and Rent

Pitching Rank and Rents

Local SEO for Beginners (...

Module 1: Introduction to Loc...

Module 2: Setting Up Your Go...

Module 15: Tracking and Reporting Progress

Overview: In this penultimate module, we focus on how to **track the progress** of your local SEO campaign and report it effectively to stakeholders (clients or your own business). SEO is ongoing, so you need to regularly measure key performance indicators (KPIs) like website traffic, search rankings, conversion rates, and other local metrics (like Google Maps views or calls). We'll outline a schedule (e.g., monthly reporting) and what to include in those reports. Additionally, we'll cover how to interpret the data – for instance, understanding seasonal trends so you don't panic if traffic dips in a slow month, or attributing which SEO activities led to improvements. By mastering tracking and reporting, you prove the value of your work and gain insights to refine your strategy continuously.

Lessons:

1. **Key Metrics to Track Over Time:** We break down the core metrics for local SEO success. These include: **Organic Traffic** (from Google Analytics, users coming via search); **Local Search Rankings** (positions for target keywords in Google – can track manually or with tools); **Google Business Profile Insights** (how many calls, direction requests, profile views you got – Google provides these stats in the GMB dashboard); **Conversions** (actual leads or sales from organic traffic – e.g., form submissions, phone

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off-site growth). By watching these, you gauge both the traffic side and the engagement side of SEO.

2. **Setting Up a Tracking Spreadsheet or Dashboard:** We suggest maintaining a simple spreadsheet where each month you log the metrics above. For example, every 1st of

Module 3: Expanding Presenc…

Module 4: Local Keyword Res…

Module 5: On-Page SEO for Y…

Module 6: Local Business Sch…

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Module 8: Building Citations

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Module 10: Online Reviews & …

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the month, record total organic sessions from last month, the number of calls from Google My Business (you can find that in the GMB insights), total Google reviews, etc. Alternatively, set up a dashboard in a tool like Google Data Studio to pull GA and GSC data automatically. The idea is to have all key metrics in one place so you can see trends. We'll provide a template of what such a report might look like.

3. **Understanding Variability and Trends:** Not every dip or spike means success or failure – context matters. We teach to compare metrics year-over-year when possible (since local businesses often have seasonal cycles – e.g., a tax accountant will always see a traffic spike in spring and a dip after). Also, when you implement changes (like a big citation build or site revamp), note the date, so if you see improvement after, you can tie it possibly to that change. Conversely, if a ranking drops, check if something happened (did a competitor ramp up, or was there a Google algorithm update around that time?). We stress not to overreact to one week's data; look at multi-week or monthly trends.

4. **Reporting to Clients or Stakeholders:** This lesson focuses on how to communicate results. A good report tells a story, not just numbers. For instance: "This month, organic traffic increased by 15%, likely due to the new city-specific landing pages we added (which started ranking for new keywords). We also moved from #5 to #3 on Google for '[Service] in [City]', which contributed to an increase in calls (we got 30 calls via Google this month, up from 20 last month). We now have 50 Google reviews (up from 45) with an average 4.7 rating." That kind of narrative helps the client see value. We also mention including a summary of work completed (e.g., "Built 10 new citations and earned a link from local chamber site") to tie efforts to outcomes.



automate some tracking. e.g., a **rank tracking tool** like BrightLocal, Moz Local or even a free one, to email you weekly rank updates. Google Analytics alerts can notify if traffic drops dramatically. GMB sends monthly summaries – incorporate that. If budget allows, tools like SEMrush can show visibility trends. However, even without expensive

tools, the combination of GA, GSC, and manual checks is sufficient.

6. **Continuous Improvement:** Finally, we instill the mindset that tracking is not just for reporting successes, but for finding improvement areas. If reports show a certain keyword has been stagnant on page 2 for months, maybe that's a signal to focus more efforts there (more content or links aimed at that term). If Google Business insights show lots of views but not many actions (clicks/calls), perhaps the profile or website needs better calls-to-action or info. Use the data to refine your SEO plan – it's a feedback loop.

Implementation Steps:

- **Choose Reporting Metrics:** Decide which metrics matter most for your client. A basic set: Organic Traffic (users and maybe new users), Keyword Rankings (for, say, 5-10 core keywords), Google My Business insights (calls, directions), Conversion count (if trackable), and number of new reviews. Add any specific to client's goals (e.g., if they care about form submissions, track that).
- **Set Up Data Collection:** In Google Analytics, ensure conversion goals are configured so you can report on leads. In Google Business Profile, note down month-end insights (you might copy from the GMB dashboard: "X views, Y searches, Z actions in the last month"). In Search Console, you can check average ranking for top queries and how that changes. If possible, use a rank tracking tool or manually search incognito to gauge where you stand for important searches.
- **Create a Template:** Build a simple report template (could be a Google Sheet or a Google Docs file). It might have a table for metrics (with columns for each month) and a section for commentary. If doing for a client, brand it with their



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- **Log Baseline Numbers:** At the start, input your baseline (maybe from the end of Module 4 or 5 when you started SEO). For example, "January: 500 organic visits, Ranking for 'Service in City' was #8, GMB calls 10." This baseline will make future changes evident.

- **Monthly Routine:** Mark your calendar near the end of each month (or whatever interval) to gather data. Export or note GA sessions, GMB calls, etc., and plug them in. Add notes: e.g., if a spike occurred, check GSC queries to see what drove it, then mention that. Or if a drop, investigate and explain (maybe “fewer working days this month due to holidays” etc.). Over time, this document becomes a history of the campaign.

- **Share and Discuss (if applicable):** If you report to a client or boss, present the key points. Use plain language alongside numbers, and relate it to their business: “Because of our improvements, 50 more people found your business on Google this month and we got 5 more calls – that could mean roughly $X more revenue if those turned into jobs.” Always connect SEO metrics to real business impact when you can.

- **Adjust Goals as Needed:** If you consistently meet certain targets (e.g., hitting a traffic goal), set new goals. If some metrics seem irrelevant, you can tweak what you track. The idea is to focus on what indicates success for the client. And as you continue all the SEO tasks, you’ll use these reports to ensure everything is trending in the right direction and adapt strategy where it’s not.

Milestone: *By the end of Module 15, you will have a system in place to continuously track and report on your local SEO performance.* The milestone can be exemplified by delivering your **first full SEO report** to the client (or for your own records) after a month of work, and then doing so regularly. The client can see progress: perhaps an X% increase in organic traffic or improved Google Maps visibility, and you can demonstrate how your efforts correlate with these improvements. Achieving transparency and clarity in results builds trust and sets the stage for the final module – tying everything together into a sustained strategy.